ROB WILCOX

Career, commercial achievements and international industry influence

Research profile | Prepared for Johnny Shanahan, Barber Republic | 1 November 2026

Executive assessment

Rob Wilcox is a professional grooming executive whose public career record spans marketing, education, entrepreneurship and leadership of Reuzel. His clearest independently documented credentials are his roles as Reuzel co-founder and CEO, supported by trade reporting and a professional barbershop account. [1, 2]

His reported earlier career includes Graham Webb and American Crew, followed by founding Freshsqueezed. These appointments help explain a career focused on connecting professional products with the people who use and sell them. The detailed dates currently rest on a secondary professional directory, rather than employer announcements. [3]

The strongest documented credentials

Reuzel co-founder and CEO: identified in this capacity by BarberX. [1]

Founding team: named by Glossy alongside Laurence Hegarty, Robert-Jan Rietvald, Leen Bergmann and David Raccuglia. [2]

Earlier marketing leadership: reported senior roles at American Crew and Graham Webb. [3]

Entrepreneurship: reported founder of Freshsqueezed from 2002. [3]

Professional brand leadership: associated with Reuzel through its development from barbering roots into a broader grooming range. [1, 4]

Scope: This is the fullest industry history supported by the public sources reviewed. Company achievements, directory-reported career details and assessment are distinguished. Public evidence is less extensive than for David Raccuglia; missing detail is not filled with assumptions.

1. Early industry experience: Graham Webb

A public professional-directory profile lists Wilcox as Director of Marketing & Education at Graham Webb from January 1991 to January 1993. This is the earliest industry appointment identified in this research. [3]

The combination of marketing and education is relevant in professional haircare, where products reach consumers through stylists, barbers and salon operators. The title indicates exposure to both disciplines; it does not establish specific campaigns, sales gains or personal awards.

2. American Crew: the formative period

The same directory records him as Senior Vice President of Marketing at American Crew from January 1994 to January 2002. American Crew officially dates its launch by David Raccuglia to 1994. If the reported dates are accurate, Wilcox worked in its early development period. [3, 5]

American Crew helped establish a distinctive professional proposition around men's grooming. Wilcox's reported marketing role is relevant to that history, but the available evidence does not isolate his personal contribution to revenue, distribution growth or campaign performance.

3. Entrepreneurship: Freshsqueezed

His directory profile lists him as CEO/founder of Freshsqueezed from January 2002. This suggests a move from a senior brand role into running his own business. [3]

The sources reviewed do not reliably establish Freshsqueezed's full client list, scale, ownership history or current operating status. Its listing as an ongoing role should not be treated as independent confirmation that he still actively runs it. The supported career point is reported founder-level entrepreneurial experience.

4. Reuzel: formation and founding team

Glossy dates Reuzel's founding to 2014 and names five founders: Laurence Hegarty, Robert-Jan Rietvald, Leen Bergmann, Rob Wilcox and David Raccuglia. Reuzel's own brand history centres on Leen and Bertus and their Rotterdam barbering roots. These accounts cover the commercial founding team and the product's barber-led origin respectively. [2, 4]

A directory dates Wilcox's CEO/co-founder role from October 2012. This precedes the reported 2014 founding or launch and may reflect preparatory activity; the precise distinction has not been verified. It is safest to retain both source qualifications. [3]

5. Executive leadership and professional presence

BarberX identifies Wilcox as Reuzel co-founder and CEO in a photograph documenting a visit involving Bertus, Schorem's shop manager, the Old School Barber Academy manager and BarberX staff and owners. This directly connects him with the brand's professional barbering community. [1]

His public LinkedIn profile places him in the Denver area and shows Reuzel-related activity, including its tenth-anniversary documentary. It also carries professional recommendations referring to his commercial creativity and ability to work across sales and marketing. These are personal endorsements, rather than independently measured performance results. [6]

6. Product and brand development

Reuzel describes expanding from its original pomades into a fuller styling and care line for different hair types and styling needs. This is a company-level development during the period associated with Wilcox's leadership. It should not be attributed to him alone: the founders, product specialists, educators and distributors also matter. [4]

7. Commercial collaboration and brand reach

In 2024, Reuzel partnered with Liquid Death on a pomade, timed to Reuzel's tenth anniversary. Glossy describes the relationship originating through Laurence Hegarty's wife's advertising connection with Liquid Death founder Mike Cessario. The collaboration is evidence of the brand reaching beyond conventional professional haircare marketing. [2]

It is a company achievement during Wilcox's leadership. The evidence does not establish that he personally originated or negotiated it. Likewise, no reliable standalone revenue, valuation or personal exit figure was established in this review.

8. Industry relationships and international relevance

The strongest named network links are to Reuzel's founding team and the Schorem professional community. His reported American Crew and Graham Webb roles add relevant historical industry exposure. An international brand role provides a reasonable basis for expecting distributor and professional relationships, but the number of active contacts available for another business remains unverified. [1-4]

Relevance to Barber Republic

Professional-market understanding: experience around the products, education and businesses that serve barbers.

Brand positioning: a reported background in marketing followed by leadership of a distinctive grooming brand.

US industry access: a Denver-based executive profile and documented professional connections may help identify introductions and early market conversations.

Commercial judgement: experience within an established grooming company could help assess routes to market. These are assessments of relevance, rather than promised outcomes.

9. Career chronology

1991-1993: reported Director of Marketing & Education, Graham Webb. [3]

1994-2002: reported Senior Vice President of Marketing, American Crew. [3]

2002 onward: reported CEO/founder, Freshsqueezed; current operating involvement unconfirmed. [3]

October 2012: directory-reported start of Reuzel CEO/co-founder role. [3]

2014: Reuzel founding/launch year reported by Glossy. [2]

2024: Reuzel tenth anniversary and Liquid Death collaboration. [2]

Suggested factual profile for investor materials

Rob Wilcox is CEO and co-founder of Reuzel, the professional grooming brand rooted in Rotterdam's Schorem barbering culture. His reported earlier career includes senior marketing roles at American Crew and Graham Webb, alongside founding Freshsqueezed. His experience combines professional grooming, brand development and executive leadership, with relevant relationships across the barbering industry.

Assessment: his interest in Barber Republic carries weight because his experience is directly related to its target industry. The practical value depends on agreed responsibilities, active introductions and specific commitments. This career profile does not establish a formal appointment or partnership.

Sources and further reading

1. BarberX - Reuzel leadership visit

2. Glossy - Reuzel founding team and Liquid Death collaboration

3. ContactOut - career dates and titles (secondary directory)

4. Reuzel - official brand history

5. American Crew - official company history

6. Rob W. - public professional profile and activity